BY ORDER OF THE COMMANDER AVIANO AIR BASE (USAFE)

AVIANO AIR BASE INSTRUCTION 11-401

8 January 2025

FLYING OPERATIONS

31ST FIGHTER WING ORIENTATION FLIGHT PROGRAM

COMPLIANCE WITH THIS PUBLICATION IS MANDATORY

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This instruction implements Air Force Policy Directive (AFPD) 11-4, *Aviation Service*. It applies to all personnel assigned to the 31st Fighter Wing (31 FW), including its Munitions Support Squadrons, and provides guidance for 31 FW orientation flights. All squadrons assigned to the 31 FW will conduct these flights in accordance with (IAW) Department of Defense (DoD) 4515.13-R, *Air Transportation Eligibility*, March 2022, Department of the Air Force Manual (DAFMAN) 11-401_DAFGM2024-01, *Aviation Management*, May 2024, United States Air Forces in Europe-Air Forces Africa (USAFE-AFAFRICA) Supplement, August 2022, and this instruction. Ensure that all records created as a result of processes prescribed in this publication are maintained in accordance with Air Force Instruction (AFI) 33-322, *Records Management and Information Governance Program*, July 2021 and disposed of in accordance with the Air Force Records Disposition Schedule **https://www.my.af.mil/afrims/afrims/rds/rds_series.cfm**. Refer recommended changes and questions about this publication to the Office of Primary Responsibility (OPR) using the DAF 847, *Recommendation for Change of Publication,* April 2022; route DAF 847s from the field through the appropriate functional's chain of command.

SUMMARY OF CHANGES

This document includes significant updates requiring a full review. Key changes are: 1) orientation flight request procedures, 2) distinguished visitor flights, 3) spouse orientation guidelines, 4) operating procedures, and 5) removal of attachments, checklists, and Mission Essential Personnel Procedures.

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1. Overview.

1.1. Authorization. MAJCOM guidance on orientation flights is provided in Chapter 5 of the DAFMAN 11-401_USAFE-AFAFRICASUP. In this guidance, Commanders may use Air Force aircraft under their control to manage the orientation flights and public affairs transportation programs in accordance with DoDI 4515.13; AFI 11-301V1, *Aircrew Flight Equipment (AFE) Program*; AFMAN 11-403, *Aerospace Physiological Training Program*; AFI 35-101, *Public Affairs Operations*, DAFMAN 48-123, *Medical Examinations and Standards*; this publication; and applicable MAJCOM supplemental guidance to the listed directives.

1.2. Purpose. This instruction adds emphasis to areas of Chapter 5 and adds specific guidance for orientation flights in 31 FW aircraft. The 31 OG/CC is the owner of the program and has made the OPR the 31 OSS/OSOS which has the responsibility of maintaining records of personnel who have flown or are awaiting flights, providing required training, and coordinating aircraft availability with squadron scheduling. While a PROJO may support events, all coordination with flying units will go directly through 31FW Scheduling.

2. Orientation Flight Authorities and Guidance

2.1. Authorities. Refer to DAFMAN 11-401_USAFE-AFAFRICASUP for the purpose the Air Force conducts orientation flights. and what is considered “Orientation flights” Reference Table 5.1 and paragraph 5.3 of the DAFMAN 11-401_USAFE-AFAFRICASUP for categories of orientation flights and the approval authority. Types of flights requiring specific flight approval authorities are listed below:

2.2. Orientation Flight Guidance. 31 FW aircraft are subject to all orientation flight guidance found in the DAFMAN 11-401_USAFE-AFAFRICASUP. The following guidance is emphasized for the 31 FW:

2.2.1. Ensure all approvals are met prior to scheduling any participant. All approval authorities are outlined in DAFMAN 11-401_USAFE-AFAFRICASUP Table 5.1.

2.2.2. Orientation flights will be local area flights that begin and return to the point of origin or a point nearby and will not be conducted to provide transportation.

2.2.3. Units with fighter, bomber, and two-seat trainer aircraft may establish an aircraft taxi-ride program. The 31 FW has established this program; reference paragraph 3.6.4 for further guidance.

2.2.4. Orientation flights will be flown within the approved flying hour program.

2.2.5. Orientation flights may be performed as a tactical sortie while not flying at the expense of Ready Aircrew Program training.

2.2.6. Fighter squadrons will plan and execute mission profiles in a low-risk environment, adhering to AFI/AFMAN 11-2MDSV3 guidelines.

2.2.7. Refer to DAFMAN 11-401_USAFE-AFAFRICASUP Chapter 5 for restrictions pertaining to all civilians and nonrated individuals. Refer to the appropriate AFI/AFMAN 11-2MDSV3 for definitions covering air combat or surface attack missions.

2.2.8. Specific Guidance for 31 FW aircraft:

2.2.8.1. The squadron operations supervisor (Top 3) and the pilot in command must consider passenger experience and training when determining which mission profile to fly.

2.2.8.2. The Adriatic Sea, designated as a combat zone under Executive Order 13119, remains open for orientation flights. Orientation passengers flying over this area are not eligible for hostile fire or imminent danger pay.

2.2.8.3. To limit complexity and task management during orientation flights, surface attack missions are defined as any mission where live weapon employment is performed including, but not limited to BDU-33, 20mm or any Full-Scale Heavy Weight employment.

3. Orientation Flight Procedures

3.1. For all orientation flights, the 31 FW Executive Officer to the Commander (31 FW/CCE) will email the signed orientation flyer memorandum to the 31 OSS/OSOS org box (31OSS.OSOS@us.af.mil). The signed memorandum is good for one orientation flight. 31 OSS/OSOS will maintain records of personnel who have flown in the current and previous year with exception to paragraph 2.3.

3.1.1. Unit SARM offices will maintain the minimum requirements in accordance with DAFMAN 11-401_USAFE-AFAFRICASUP. Unit SARM will verify all flight requirements have been met prior to step.

3.2. Distinguished Visitor Flights.

3.2.1. 31 FW/CCE will serve as the primary point of contact for DV (DV Code 7 and above) orientation flights and will work in concert with 31 OG/OGV and the assigned 31 FW PROJO to obtain approval if not qualified with WG/CC approval per DAFMAN 11-401_USAFE-AFAFAFRICASUP. Email 31 OSS/OSOS (31OSS.OSOS@us.af.mil) for current request template.

3.2.2. Once the DV flight MFR is approved, the PROJO will notify 31 FW Protocol and 31 OG/CC, and email the MFR to 31 OSS/OSO (31OSS.OSOS@us.af.mil). 31 FW Protocol will notify the flying squadron of any special considerations that must be accomplished when hosting the DV.

3.3. One-time Orientation Flights.

3.3.1. All U.S. and foreign military members, and DoD civilian employees assigned to

Aviano Air Base, may be authorized a one-time orientation flight IAW DAFMAN 11-401_USAFE-AFAFRICASUP table 5.1 approval authorities. These members must have direct approval from the 31 FW/CC to participate in these flights. Supervisors or PROJOs can request priority adjustments by following 31 OSS/OSOS procedures. The final authority for priority adjustment is the WG/CCC.

3.4. Spouse Orientation Flights.

3.4.1. Refer to DAFMAN 11-401_USAFE-AFAFAFRICASUP chapter 5 for Spouse orientation flights.

3.4.2. Spouse Orientation Flights on HH-60 aircraft.

3.4.2.1. 56 RQS will assign a PROJO to coordinate event approval with 31 OG/CC at least 30 days prior.

3.4.2.2. Spouse's will have a medical clearance and sign a liability release (DD Form 1381, Air Transportation Agreement) prior to flight. Medical clearance will be coordinated through 56 RQS assigned flight surgeon or the 31st Medical Group Aerospace Medicine Squadron Flight Surgeon's office.

3.4.2.3. The PROJO and 56 RQS SARM are responsible for ensuring individual training and preparation is properly coordinated and scheduled. The PROJO will provide 31 OSS/OSOS with all spouses flown for tracking and record keeping.

3.4.3. Spouse Orientation Flight on Non-31 FW aircraft.

3.4.3.1. Spouse orientation flights on visiting aircraft are coordinated on a space-available basis, with the owning WG/CC of the visiting aircraft as the approval authority.

3.4.3.2. The 31 FW PROJO for the event will coordinate names and any other information required from the owning unit to approve the orientation flights and will work with owning unit and aircraft commanders to determine the flight schedule. The PROJO will forward the list of names to the 31st Medical Group Aerospace Medicine Squadron Flight Surgeon's office for medical clearance. Contact 31 OSS/OSOS for the latest example coordination memorandum.

3.4.3.3. Requirements prior to flight are dictated by the host unit's MAJCOM supplement and may change from event to event. The PROJO will coordinate training for host unit requirements for each event.

3.4.3.4. The 31FW PROJO will provide the owning unit with the names of all spouses flown for tracking and record keeping.

3.4.4. Spouse Taxi-Ride Program.

3.4.4.1. The 31FW F-16's are approved for a Spouse Taxi-Ride Program, limited to spouses of active-duty USAF personnel. The 510 FS & 555 FS will each assign a PROJO to coordinate event approval with 31 OG/CC at least 30 days prior.

3.4.4.2. Spouse Taxi Ride Program Requirements. The assigned PROJO will coordinate with the owning unit SARM NCOIC and provide any required information to ensure individual training and preparation is properly coordinated and scheduled. In addition to the requirements outlined in the AFMAN 11-401USAFE-AFAFAFRICASUP paragraph 5.2.1.9.6, the following items must also be completed prior or during the taxi-ride, as applicable:

3.6.4.3.1. The pilot thoroughly briefs participants on cockpit orientation and critical switches and ensures physical capability for possible emergency ground

egress.

3.6.4.3.2. Complete appropriate hot brakes/wheel inspections (as required) between taxi trips.

3.6.4.3.3. Pilots will not exceed 100 knots maximum speed during the acceleration roll.

3.6.4.3.4. Do not remove ejection seat pins under any circumstances.

4. Orientation Flight Execution.

4.1. Scheduling and Notification.

4.1.1. Scheduling. In the weekly Wednesday scheduling meeting, 31 OSS/OSOS will confirm aircraft availability with squadron schedulers for the upcoming week.

4.1.2. Notification. Approved candidates and their leadership will be notified of orientation flight opportunities via email and phone call to squadron CSS.

4.1.2.1. Email. The email will include the training schedule, locations, a signed approval memorandum (per DAFMAN 11-401_USAFE-AFAFRICASUP Chapter 5), and the required checklist. Candidates must complete the checklist fully before the flight, including summaries for ejection and non-ejection seat familiarization. Training summaries for ejection and non-ejection seat familiarization are provided in the 31 OSS/OSOS Orientation Flyer Checklist.

4.1.2.2. Confirmation Deadline. Nominees must confirm availability by 1200L on Friday of the prior week. A lack of response will be considered a decline, with rescheduling handled on a case-by-case basis.

4.1.3. Flight Priorities. 31 OSS/OSOS manages the final order of candidates for orientation flights, with Flight Doctors and Aerospace Physiologists receiving priority for Monday and Friday slots. The 31 OSS/OSOS is not responsible for moving participants up in priority.

4.2. Training and Preparation.

4.2.1. Mass Training Schedule. Orientation flights will align with the OSS mass training schedule, including the 31 FW Aircrew Flight Equipment, Aerospace Physiology, the flight surgeon's office, and SERE. Standard times for mass training will be outlined in the initial notification email from 31 OSS/OSOS.

4.2.2. Training Requirements. All medical and training requirements for orientation flights must follow the Orientation Flyer Checklist from 31 OSS/OSOS.

4.2.2.1. Medical Clearance: The Flight Surgeon will provide a DD Form 2992 medical clearance to each candidate. If any physical capability issues arise, they will be referred to the flying unit for final determination.

4.3. Pre-Flight Verification.

4.3.1. Checklist and Documentation. Unit SARM will verify the Orientation Flyer Checklist is complete and that all training requirements are met in line with DAFMAN 11-401_USAFE-AFAFRICASUP before the candidate steps for the flight. All documents will be maintained at the unit SARM per DAFMAN 11-401_USAFE-AFAFRICASUP.

4.3.2. The FS and/or RQS Operations Supervisor (Top 3) will be the final execution authority for the orientation flight.

4.4. Contingencies.

4.4.1. Rescheduling: If maintenance, weather, or other factors prevent the flight, it will be rescheduled for the next available slot as mission requirements permit.

4.4.2. Missed Training or Arrival: Candidates who miss scheduled training or fail to arrive on time may forfeit their flight and will not be rescheduled.

TAD D. CLARK, Brigadier General, USAF

Commander

Attachment 1

GLOSSARY OF REFERENCES AND SUPPORTING INFORMATION

References

DAFMAN 11-401, *Aviation Management, 27 October 2020*, DAFGM2024-01 23 MAY 2024

DAFMAN 11-401, *Aviation Management*, USAFE-AFAFRICA Supplement, 22 August 2022

AFMAN 11-403, *Aerospace Physiological Training Program*, 18 March 2024

AFI 16-1301, *Survival, Evasion, Resistance and Escape* (SERE) *Program*, 3 August 2017

AFMAN 11-301*, Aircrew Flight Equipment* (AFE) *Program*, 31 May 2023, AFGM2023-02 23 October 2023

DAFMAN 48-123, *Medical Examinations and Standa*rds, 08 December 2020, DAFGM2024-01 20 February 2024

AFI 33-322, *Records Management and Information Governance Program*, 23 March 2020

Prescribed Forms

DD Form 1381, Air Transportation Agreement

DD Form 2992, Medical Recommendation for Flying or Special Operational Duty

Adopted Forms

AF 847, Recommendation for Change of Publication

Acronyms and Abbreviations

DEROS—Date Eligible to Return from Overseas

DV—Distinguished Visitor

PROJO—Project Officer

SARM—Squadron Aviation Resource Management

SERE—Survival Evasion Resistance Escape

SMA—Special Mission Aviator